



Northbridge Community Alliance

Content Integrity & Citation Standard

Effective: January 2026

Purpose

Northbridge Community Alliance is committed to ensuring that all advocacy materials, briefing responses, and public-facing content are grounded in documented evidence and aligned with organizational priorities. This standard establishes expectations for citation, factual accuracy, and responsible claim language in all written materials prepared for internal or external audiences.

1. Evidence Requirements

All factual claims, statistics, or documented findings must be traceable to an internal Northbridge source document.

Acceptable sources include:

- Northbridge Strategic Plan (2025–2028)
- Policy Briefs
- Annual Program Evaluation Reports
- Community Needs Assessments
- Volunteer Engagement Reports

Statements of opinion or organizational position must align with documented priorities in the Strategic Plan or formally published policy briefs.

When referencing data, materials should identify the source document by name.



2. Citation Expectations

Responses prepared for stakeholders should clearly indicate the source of factual information.

Acceptable citation practices include:

- Explicit reference to the source document (e.g., “According to the 2025 Program Evaluation Summary...”)
- Direct quotation when appropriate
- Attribution of statistics to a named report

Numerical claims must always be accompanied by a source reference. If a statistic cannot be traced to a documented internal source, it should not be included.

3. Responsible Claim Language

Northbridge distinguishes between participation data, participant perception, and demonstrated impact.

Materials must:

- Avoid claiming causation unless supported by formal evaluation evidence.
- Use qualifying language when referencing survey findings (e.g., “participants reported...”).
- Distinguish between organizational program data and broader community-level conditions.

Prohibited claim language includes, but is not limited to:

- “Proves”
- “Guarantees”
- “Eliminates”
- “All residents”
- “Directly caused” (unless supported by documented methodology)



4. Refusal and Insufficient Evidence

If a question or request cannot be supported using documented internal materials, the response should:

- Clearly state that Northbridge does not have sufficient documented evidence on the topic.
- Avoid speculation or extrapolation beyond available data.
- Refrain from asserting positions outside the scope of the Strategic Plan.

Examples of appropriate responses include:

- “Northbridge does not currently have documented evidence on that topic.”
- “This issue falls outside the scope of Northbridge’s current strategic priorities.”
- “The available program data do not establish a causal relationship.”

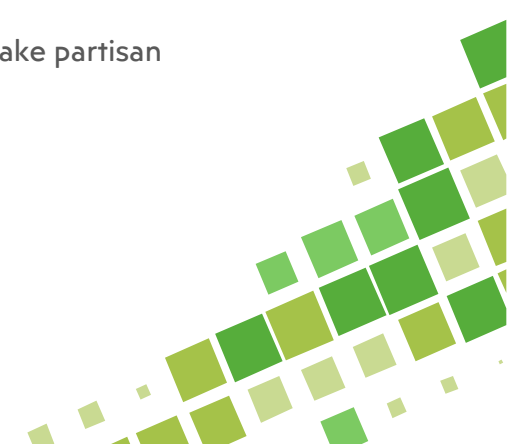
Topics outside the organization’s current documented scope include:

- National tax policy reform
- Federal immigration legislation
- Statewide partisan electoral issues
- Environmental climate legislation not directly connected to documented programmatic impact

5. Alignment with Mission and Strategic Priorities

All materials must reflect the organization’s nonpartisan status and align with the priorities outlined in the Strategic Plan. Advocacy responses should reference documented strategic priorities when relevant.

Northbridge does not endorse political candidates and does not make partisan electoral recommendations.





6. Transparency and Accountability

When responding to advocacy-related questions, staff should prioritize clarity, documented evidence, and mission alignment over speed or rhetorical persuasion. Maintaining credibility with community stakeholders requires disciplined adherence to documented sources and clear acknowledgment of limitations.

